



DAVAO DEL NORTE STATE COLLEGE

LEARNING CONTINUITY PLAN (LCP)

AND

IMPLEMENTATION OF FLEXIBLE LEARNING

2021 and beyond

**DAVAO DEL NORTE STATE COLLEGE
New Visayas, Panabo City**



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LEARNING CONTINUITY PLAN

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The current global situation suggests that the threat of the virus will be existent for a long period of time. As such, the Philippine government mandated the various sectors including the HEIs to prepare plans and programs in order to continue their operation and deliver the expected quality teaching/learning under the “new normal” scenario. The biggest challenge of the pandemic arises from the need to practice stringent social or physical distancing to prevent or mitigate the spread of Covid-19. This implies minimal face to face interaction of classes and other school activities for School Year 2020-2021. The DNSC formulated mechanisms and ways to continue the learning amidst the threat brought about by COVID-19, while ensuring the health, safety, and well-being of all students, faculty, staff and administration.

The DNSC Learning Continuity Plan (LCP) was guided by the by the Issuances of National Governments, CHED and Local Government Units which are also guided by the Department of Health (DOH) and the Inter-Agency Task Force for the Management of Emerging Infectious Diseases in the Philippines (IATF). Moreover, this is guided by the following objectives:

1. Protect the health, safety and well-being of students, teachers, and personnel, and prevent the further transmission of COVID-19;
2. Ensure learning continuity deployment of Flexible Learning through multiple learning delivery modalities,
3. Provide training for Faculty and personnel to support the LCP implementation;
4. Provide Facilities and procedures to facilitate the learning continuity and health safety of DNSC constituents; and
5. Ensure accessible services and communication with internal and external clients

In developing the DNSC LCP, the College conducted assessment on the on-line Capacity of both students and Faculty and decided the opening of SY 2020-2021 on August 31, 2020, allowing enough time to undertake the necessary preparations for the challenging school year embracing the new normal. DNSC shall deliver instructions in a flexible way without compromising the quality of instruction and learning experiences of students. Hence, the DNSC shall implement a combination of delivery of online, and blended Learning.

The key elements of the learning strategies that shall operationalize the LCP is streamlining Curriculum into the most Essential Learning Competencies (MELCs), and allowing of multiple learning delivery modalities such as blended and flexible learning in lieu of face-to-face learning through asynchronous or asynchronous mode of delivery.

The DNSC uses Self-Learning Modules in offline/online digital formats and print (for those with no internet connection). The College also maximize the use of Learning Management System (LMS) for these modalities.

The learning outcomes in the form of knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values will be assessed through written works and performances, whether hardcopy, softcopy or a combination of these, and through formative and summative tests (Midterm and Final Exams) with appropriate safeguards using appropriate technology.

To prepare the faculty and staff for multiple learning delivery modalities, they shall be continuously capacitated to implement the learning delivery system. As such, the faculty are capacitated both on on-line and off-line mode of instruction. Moreover, DNSC shall address student and faculty level issues on no/slow internet connectivity, limited ICT Infrastructure and on-line gadgets. Effective communication system was established for DNSC internal and external clients and it plays a major role in implementing the LCP. Finally, a monitoring system through various modes (meetings, research, use of LMS) are in placed to provide basis for continual improvement.



Implementation of Learning Continuity Plan

I. FRAMEWORK FOR LEARNING CONTINUITY PLAN

The Framework for learning continuity under the new normal shall be composed of Institutional System, Policies, Stakeholders participation and Monitoring and Evaluation. It is expected that the Faculty, students and personnel demonstrates resilience in responding to Covid19 adversities and in maintains quality in delivering its commitment to quality instruction and services.



Fig. 1. Framework of the Flexible Learning to implement the Learning Continuity Plan.



II. INSTITUTIONAL SYSTEMS, PROCEDURES AND STRUCTURES TO TRANSITION TO FLEXIBLE LEARNING:

A. Information Technology Services Office

The Information Technology Services Office (ITSO) was created to provide the quality service responsive to and meeting the information needs and computerization requirements of both the academic community and administrative units at the Davao del Norte State College.

The ITSO supervises, coordinates and controls the IT environmental scanning for administrative applicability in the College, the development and provision of the College data, computer and network facilities, information systems and services, and the design and/or improvement of the College processes with the ultimate goal that the services effectively respond to the requirements and overall plan for the DNSC System.

B. Covid19 Task Force

The DNSC Covid19 Task Force was created (Special Order No. 069) to develop implement, strengthen and maintain College-Wide Covid 19 Preventive and control measures to safeguard the health and safety of Students, faculty and Staff and the DNSC community consistent to the IATF orders and issuances.

C. Center for Learning and Resource Development

The Center for Learning and Resource Development (CLRD) was created (SO No. 166, series of 2019) to review and enhance instructional materials ready for reproduction and use to be adopted to specific curriculum for the program. Instructional materials development and review shall follow the IM Policy Guidelines of the Davao del Norte State College duly approved by the Board of Trustees. During the covid-19 pandemic, it was strengthened to collaborate with the Academic Units shall implement Module/IM Development and reproduction of printed materials for off-line Instructional Materials to be used by students with poor or no internet connectivity.

A. Resources

C.1. Facilities and ICT Infrastructure

Internet Connectivity and on-line systems and services

The college has Internet connectivity with a maximum speed of 102.4 MB/s, with an interface of 1.37.26.227 with a traffic analysis for 120.28.46.25@IC-AOZ-9045.

The College maximized the use of its resources to enhance the ICT Infrastructure to maximize the use of DNSC iaims, Learning Management System, Link Biz (LBP) and other online platforms in the enrollment, guidance and student services and instructional delivery, to be able to reach the stakeholders even during the pandemic crisis.

E.3. Budget, Plans and Directions

The College assessed the projects, programs and activities (PPAs) which may not be possibly conducted due to avoidance of face to face transactions. Funds intended for such PAPs that may not be implemented in 2020 were re-aligned to support the Transition, Post-Enhanced Community Quarantine (Post-ECQ) Operations, and Recovery Plan.

A proposal was made which aims to capacitate the DNSC Faculty towards Flexible Learning to increase opportunities and options available to learners through a variety of learning modes and interactions while preventing the spread of Covid 19. The proposal aims to a) capacitate Faculty on Learning Management System and Other On-line Platforms; b) develop varied Modules and Instructional Materials (Print and non-print) that suit the needs of the learners; c) enhance ICT



Infrastructures (laptops and computers), LMS and Internet Connectivity; and 4) provide Covid19 Prevention facilities and Procedures.

III. INSTRUCTIONAL DELIVERY AND SUPPORT SERVICES

A. Modes of Delivering Instruction

A DNSC guideline in concluding the 2nd Semester, AY 2019-2020, interim modifications to the Academic policies, Post-ECQ Operations, Transition and Recovery Plan was approved by the DNSC Governing Board through BOT Resolution No. 4, series of 2020. Hence, there shall be no more face-to-face instruction for the rest of the semester. The faculty are directed to exhaust all possible means to reach out to their students. The faculty may deploy Alternative Modes of Delivery which do not necessarily require internet connectivity in disseminating the remaining requirements of their subjects. These requirements shall be made available to students anytime at their convenience through the DNSC Learning Management System and/or through different modes of communication. All student requirements which can be submitted electronically or through hard/printed copy, depending on what is more convenient for the student/teacher, provided that strict physical distancing is observed. The faculty work at home scheme shall be assessed by the Deans through the submission of accomplishment report, a pre-requisite for the release of salary.

For the modalities of learning, the College shall implement the Flexible Learning for the delivery of instruction and shall apply both synchronous and asynchronous mode of learning. This provides sufficient flexibility to meet the varied needs and abilities of the students served Synchronous Learning shall take place in realtime with groups of learners (e.g. live webinars, virtual classrooms, instant messaging). This shall be undertaken during the scheduled class to avoid conflict with other classes. Asynchronous Learning shall take place at different times and students complete their courses/modules at their own time regardless of location at their convenience. This can be done through the use of modules (printed ordownloaded online via LMS or other on-line Platforms).

B. Learning Management System

DNSC uses LMS Moodle, a free and open-source learning platform. Thus, is fully maximized to improve learner engagement and execute remote learning efforts. This platform includes features to manage students submission, examination and collaboration. This will also facilitate Supervisors’ monitoring of faculty instructional materials and outputs.

C. DNSC Emails

All faculty and students are provided with official DNSC emails to be used in accessing the DNSC Student and Faculty Portals (DNSC iaims) and Learning Management system.

The college shall plan and deliver content in multiple ways so all students can access learning. Depending on the duration of limited face to face interaction, the learning scenarios shall vary (Table below).

Area of Concern	No Face to Face Inter-action Learning Scenarios	
	Short Term (4-6 months)	Mid-Long Term (7 months to 2 years)
Content	Content shall be based on the syllabus but shall be modified based on the limitations of the situation	Content shall be based on the approved syllabus of each course.
Timetable	Faculty deliver classes as identified by a modified school timetable, subjects.	Faculty deliver classes as identified in the timetable of the course
Delivery of	Asynchronous Learning using offline	Modes of instruction may include use



Instruction	Instructional Materials and assignments. All classes prepare and send home a timetable of activities with daily focus on reading and writing.	of online learning, telephone communications, email, virtual instruction, videos, slideshows, project-based learning, use of instructional modules, or a combination to meet diverse student needs.
Attendance	Not required for grading but based on the submission of requirements. Attendance will be used for monitoring and intervention.	Not required for grading but based on the submission of requirements.
Engagements	Engage Students: Communicate with the students by any means of communication.	Engage Families: Communicate with families about engagement strategies to support students as they access the learning.

D. Support Services for students and faculty

- a. Institutionalizing the online psychological support group/service

DNSC Online Psychological Support Group which was formed by The Office of the Student Services, through the Guidance Services Unit and which aims to provide counselling and peer assistance to the DNSC community shall be institutionalized and mobilized more to cater to greater number of clients, may they be students, faculty, or staff experiencing psychological distress during this situation. The group shall be composed of Guidance Counselors, Volunteer Social Science Faculty Members, and Peer Facilitators.

- b. DNSC e-guidance Services Telecounseling, Consulting and Testing.

The Counseling is the core of the guidance program, it is the heart of the guidance services and it has the following features: a) Face to face counselling is shift into telecounseling; b) Different platforms will be used like doxy.me, google meet, zoom, messenger and to those with very low internet connection we can make use of phone calls for our counseling sessions; c) Faculty, DNSC employees, students and parents may refer a student, friend, classmates, daughter or son for telecounseling can avail the services; d) By setting an appointment with the guidance services, client can have virtual talk to a Guidance Counselor using doxy.me, google meet, zoom, messenger or through phone call and can undergo online personality test, career inventory, emotional quotient test and the likes, you may set an appointment for testing and interpretation. The following are the steps to avail of the e-Guidance Services

1. Fill-out the appointment form using this link <https://tinyurl.com/y2exatxp>
2. Wait for a confirmation text from the Guidance personnel.
3. For Tele counseling, the Guidance Counselor will send the informed consent and the counselling information form to the student through e-mail or messenger.
4. The student will send back the filled-out forms.
5. Guidance personnel will conduct the service
6. Student will fill-out the learning log using the link provided
7. Follow-up if applicable Wellness

Group guidance activities will be given to students who will signify their interest to attend in various topics like mindful exercises, self-awareness, conflict management and more and to those identified students who need intervention and support. Short courses/modular training/webinars like mental health, effective study habits, stress management and others will be available in DNSC LMS and google classroom and will be given to interested students in an asynchronous mode. You can go through these courses at your own time and pace. Then, you will be given certificate of completion after finishing the course



- Remote psychological first aid

c. Career Guidance

1. Virtual Career and Job fairs
2. Virtual livelihood Trainings/demonstration
3. Webinars (labor education, pre-employment seminars, anti-illegal recruitment campaign, etc.)
4. Online job posting
5. Referral to employees
6. Labor market system
7. PhilJobNet
8. Public Employment Information System (PEIS)

d. Library Services

The DNSC LIRC supports the instructional, recreational, research, extension, production and other programs of the College by selecting, acquiring, organizing, classifying, preserving and conserving quality information materials for the intellectual needs of its customers who are the students, faculty, staff, management, as well as the community users. With this, the LIRC management endeavors that all the customers will find the LIRC a venue where they can get answers to their queries in their search for knowledge.

The LIRC provides the students excellent avenues/services and an environment that will further develop their physical, psychological, social, political, cultural, spiritual, moral, and intellectual aspects as well as academic potentials geared towards holistic growth and development.

Components Library

Integrated Library– depository and sources of all forms of print materials like books, periodicals (newspapers, magazines, journals, etc.), Vertical Files (pamphlets, clippings, leaflets, modules, brochures, etc.), unpublished materials (dissertations, theses, feasibility studies, narrative reports, etc.), novels and other forms.

Audio-Visual Hall

The Audio-Visual Hall is a place for multimedia/non-print resources. It is used for film showing, demonstration, and other activities related to classroom instruction using the facilities available. It is also a venue for the conduct of seminars, conferences, meetings, workshops, and other activities of the College.

Electronic Library (E-lib)

This facility uses computers for online searching of credible materials like online databases, e-book searching, video viewing, encoding, printing, and others. The e-lib services that you can avail are the following: off-line and on-line electronic library systems, e-encyclopedia, encoding, printing, and e-mailing.

During the New Normal, the LIRC provides on-line library Services to students and Faculty. For Visibility and easy access, the links to Open Educational Resources (OERs) and on-line resources are also provided in the DNSC Learning management System which can be accessed by both faculty and students.

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During the New Normal, the LIRC provides on-line library Services to students and Faculty. For Visibility and easy access, the links to on-line resources are also provided in the DNSC Learning Management System (**LMS**).

Online Resources Links

- <https://bccampu.ca/>
- <https://openstax.org/>
- <https://oasis.geneseo.edu/index.php>
- <https://OER.deepwebaccess.com/oer/desktop/en/search.html>
- <https://www.merlot.org/merlot/>
- <https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks>
- bit.ly/Freelipiniana.
- bit.ly/FOLlaunch
- https://www.scribendi.com/advice/free_online_journal-and_research_databases.en.html
- <https://doaj.org/>
- <https://core.ac.uk/>
- <https://www.cia.gov/library/publications/the-world-factbook/geos/xx.html>
- <https://www.biomedcentral.com/>
- <https://eric.ed.gov/>
- <https://datadryad.org/stash>
- <https://ethos.bl.uk/Home.do>
- <https://dblp.org/>
- <https://www.ssrn.com/index.cfm/en/>
- <https://ethos.bl.uk/Home.do>
- <https://dblp.org/>
- <https://www.ssrn.com/index.cfm/en/>
- <https://www.semanticscholar.org/>
- <https://plos.org/>
- <https://arxiv.org/>
- <https://zenodo.org/>
- <http://alarm.upmin.edu.ph>
- <https://tinyurl.com/y9x7736w>
- <https://bookboon.com/>

Note: Policies for the use OERs is on-progress

E. Teaching and learning activities and requirements

a. Teaching and learning activities

The College shall implement the Flexible Learning Mode for the delivery of instruction and shall apply both synchronous and asynchronous learning. Synchronous Learning shall take place in realtime with groups of learners (e.g. live webinars, virtual classrooms, instant messaging). This shall be undertaken during the scheduled class to avoid conflict with other classes. Asynchronous Learning shall take place at different times and students complete their courses/modules at their own time regardless of location at their convenience. This can be done through the use of modules (printed or downloaded online via LMS or other on-line Platforms).

Faculty are required to meet the students in the class virtually on the first day of class through any mode of communication. The Institute concerned will provide the faculty with contact numbers and emails of the students in their respective classes. Each class is required to create a communication venue (e.g. chat group) to facilitate fast exchange of information between the



students and Faculty. During the first day virtual meeting, please facilitate the following:

1. Provide and discuss (if possible) the course outline;
2. Set a schedule for consultation period every two weeks to accommodate questions and clarification from the students;
3. Provide students with learning module/activity for a specified period of the class through DNSC LMS and additionally in any on-line platforms accessible to the students.

The synchronous classes, if scheduled shall be done within the class schedules and attendance shall be monitored using the prescribed forms for attendance sheet. During the new normal, all are still bound to adhere to the schedule of classes. Class consultations and all synchronous classes shall be done within the class schedules only and attendance shall be monitored. Make-up classes, or classes conducted outside the class schedule shall require a permit at the Institute Level.

b. Submission of Requirements

The faculty is given the academic freedom to decide for the requirements for each course provided, it is consistent with the expected learning outcomes based on the approved syllabus. This may include formative and summative test, projects and performances.

Students are required to submit the requirements set by the faculty. Deadline for the submission of requirements is flexible depending on the arrangement of the faculty and students and the timeline set by the syllabus.

F. Assessment of effectiveness Instruction and Integrity

Formative Assessment

The faculty are required to provide students with Self Learning Modules as instructional material for each course. The modules include activity, analysis, abstraction, application, assessment (optional) most of which form part of the formative test/assessment. Moreover, Faculty may require quiz and other requirements which mode of submission shall be dependent on the students situation.

Summative Assessment

Summative Test which include midterm and final examination is required and shall follow asynchronous mode with the multiple ways to be flexible in the assessments which duration is set for one week. However, this shall be set for one-time access and submission with appropriate safeguards using LMS or Google Forms. Asynchronous examination shall be in any form (e.g. traditional summative test, performance test, creative test, reflections) as long as it is consistent with the learning outcomes as specified in the syllabus. Students who cannot access with the on-line examination shall be contacted and given special arrangements. However, this shall be reported first and be verified by the Dean and Program Chairperson.

G. OJT/Practicum

On-the-Job Training (OJT) and Internship during ECQ

DNSC guideline in concluding the 2nd Semester, AY 2019-2020, interim modifications to the Academic policies, Post-ECQ Operations, Transition and Recovery Plan)

OJT students who have been pulled out from their respective training centers shall not be allowed to go back to their respective host companies or agencies and will be given alternative requirements by the Institute concerned. OJT of Graduating Students who need to complete their academic requirements shall be conducted at DNSC campus in the different research, extension and production projects of the DNSC, subject to compliance of the same requirements. Since



OJT requires practicum activities, the OJT Supervisors shall emphasize strict observance of social distancing and other safety requirements.

Up-Coming On-the-Job Training (OJT) and Internship

To minimize the risk of exposure of students to Covid 19 virus, Aid students in taking their OJT while still meeting the basic required competency, an alternative task will be given to students that will still enable them to have practical application of the theories learned. OJT students are be given alternative OJT requirements through on-line activities (Webinar, Lecture, Videos, Practice Teaching) by their respective deans, program chairs and OJT coordinators to complete with the required number of contact hours. As such, OJT Supervisors shall be designated in the host department and shall provide the daily tasks and criteria for evaluation of students' performance to be approved by the College. The OJT supervisors shall devise mechanism for the implementation of flexible modalities in the conduct of the OJT program, such as proper scheduling of OJT students, to promote minimal (if needed) or no entry within the College premises.

IV. POLICIES

A. Enrollment and Admission

DNSC guideline in concluding the 2nd Semester, AY 2019-2020, interim modifications to the Academic policies, Post-ECQ Operations, Transition and Recovery Plan)

Application for Admission and Enrollment

During the General Community Quarantine, the DNSC shall determine appropriate mode of admission and enrollment procedures which will not compromise the health of its personnel and students. Thus, a modification of admission, enrollment, retention procedures and enhancement of communication system shall be implemented.

The college entrance test will no longer be required for admission of freshmen and transferee students. Those who were already given the College Entrance Exam will be prioritized for admission.

Application for admission will be done by registering online. Online Application User Guide should be followed. The Program preference will be selected and the following documents will be uploaded for evaluation purposes:

Incoming Freshmen Students

1. Report Card
2. PSA or NSO Birth Certificate or Clear Copy of the Original Birth Certificate Issued by the Local Civil Registrar
3. Good Moral Certificate
4. Self-Certification of the Authenticity of the Uploaded Documents

Transferees

1. Honorable Dismissal
2. Official Transcript Records (for evaluation purposes)
3. PSA or NSO Birth Certificate or Clear Copy of the Original Birth Certificate Issued by the Local Civil Registrar
4. Self-Certification of the Authenticity of the Uploaded Documents

Returning Students

1. Student's Clearance
2. Certificate of Rating/Grades or Evaluation Sheet from the Registrar's Office or thru



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IAIMS

3. Written Permission of Enrollment (Issued by the Dean or Program Chairperson)
4. Approved Leave of Absence (LOA), if applicable
5. Self-Certification of the Authenticity of the Uploaded Documents

Shiftee Students

1. Student's Clearance
2. Certificate of Rating/Grades or Evaluation Sheet thru IAIMS
3. Application for Credit of Subjects
4. Written Permission of Enrollment (Issued by the Dean or Program Chairperson)- Application for Shift of Course/Program and Major
5. Approved Leave of Absence (LOA), if applicable
6. Self-Certification of the Authenticity of the Uploaded Documents
7. Graduate School Students

Honorable Dismissal

1. Transcript of Records for Evaluation Purposes
2. PSA or NSO Birth Certificate or Clear Copy of the Original Birth Certificate Issued by the Local Civil Registrar
3. Self-Certification of the Authenticity of the Uploaded Documents

Documents and other requirements to be submitted immediately after the lifting of Community Quarantine:

1. Original copies of the uploaded documents
2. Medical Certificate (Issued by a Government Physician, original copy)
3. Drug Test Result (From a DOH/DNSC-Accredited Clinic/Laboratory or Hospital)
4. Copies of Recent 2x2 Picture, preferably in white background (4 pcs)
5. Long brown envelopes (3 pcs)
6. Form 137-A (through a request form- Incoming Freshmen only)
7. Official Transcript of Records (Transferees only)

Once submitted, these credentials/requirements shall become part of the student's permanent record in the College.

The Admission office through its authorized personnel will assess the uploaded documents. Prospective applicants will be forwarded to the Program/Institute concerned for Interview and further assessment based on the admission requirements. Once the applicant qualifies, she/he will be accepted, then, the Institute will confirm the enrollment of the student. Enrollment of students will be done on a first come first serve basis. The Institute will forward the admitted applicants to the admission office.

The Admission Office will officially communicate to the student applicants the result of their admission application within two (2) working days after the online registration via different modes of communication.

Prescribed admission requirements shall be followed, however flexibilities on these requirements may be done will be based on case to case basis and primarily based on merit.

Incoming freshmen students including the parents shall be oriented on the technology-mediated flexible teaching and learning which requires internet and online gadgets so the students are ready during the opening of classes.



B. Attendance

Students

Attendance of students should be checked in a consistent whether in absences are occurring during synchronous and asynchronous (remote) classes. To ensure data is meaningful, districts should, if it does not already exist, establish a common definition of what constitutes a day of attendance during remote as well as in-person instruction. Data on absences and attendance can be used to notice which students have habitual absences. Knowing which and how many students fall into these attendance bands can inform Programs and Institute Deans strategies for reducing chronic absence, and also help indicate the level of support that may be needed for individual students and families as well as groups of students.

DNSC Employees

Pursuant to CSC rules and regulations, the faculty shall be under workat home scheme and shall have minimal attendance/physical reporting to the College. Work from Home Scheme shall be assessed by the Deans through the submission of accomplishment report and instructional outputs. Faculty accomplishments shall be submitted using the appropriate forms.

The DNSC shall adopt its own workforce measures through “Skeletal Workforce” to ensure the continuity of frontline and essential services, such as the processing of salary claims and supplies and materials, security services and management including its support to the ongoing measures to contain the spread of the new coronavirus. As such, the frontline services shall compose the skeletal workforce of the College but not limited to the following: 1. Security Services 2. General Services 3. Finance Services 4. Medical services 5. Human Resource Services 6. Supply and Procurement Services 7. Top Management. The DNSC shall ensure that through this skeletal workforce, the College operation is maintained. Shifting of employees of the different frontline services shall be scheduled to provide regular workforce from Monday to Friday.

The frequency of reporting of DNSC Personnel will be dependent on the IATF classification of the Province of Davao del Norte which is dependent on the number of covid-19 cases in the locality.

C. Reporting and updating of student-teacher engagement

As the college is monitoring the responses of students in this new normal due to the Covid 19 pandemic. The DNSC faculty set a schedule for consultation period every two weeks to accommodate questions and clarification from the students. Faculty to provide students with modules/activities through LMS or anyon-line platforms but all instructional materials shall be uploaded in theDNSC LMS for monitoring purposes.

Faculty shall fully utilize the DNSC Learning Management System to provide learning materials to students and for monitoring purposes. For every class, you will enroll the students to your LMS using their DNSC email accounts. The Deans and Program Chairpersons shall also be enrolled in the LMS of faculty as a co-teacher for monitoring and mentoring purposes. Modules and instructional materials duly checked by the Institute/Department shall be uploaded to the LMS before the scheduled class.

Monitoring Report on the Status of LMS Utilization by Faculty andStudents shall be done regularly.

D. Grades and grading system (adopted from the Students Handbook)

The work of students in higher education shall be graded at the end of each term in accordance with the prescribed grading system.

The grading system Shall be uniform using number grades in multiplesof .25 from 1 to 5 where1



is the highest and 3 is the lowest passing grade. No grade of 4 shall be given as final rating. Students shall be rated in accordance with weight distribution established by the department/Unit and- in accordance with the following system:

A student who has received a passing grade in a given course is not allowed to take another examination for the purpose of improving his grade. Students with failing grades are subject to the provision of item retention and scholastic delinquency.

The college reserves the right to establish a standard in computing grades based on the approval grading system to be approved by the academic council.

Submission of grades

Every faculty member shall submit his/her report of grades in an official grading sheet at the DNSC Integrated Academic Information Management System (IAIMS).

Computation and Submission of Grades during the ECQ

The faculty has the **freedom** to determine the students' final grades based on the available data on their students' performance from the start of the semester until the suspension of classes on 12 March 2020 as well as other requirements submitted until the deadline for submission of requirements. Students' grades shall be based on clear evidence of their performance and such shall be consistent with the grading requirements specified in the syllabus subject to modifications if deemed necessary.

Faculty members shall exercise greater flexibility, openness and special considerations for their students. **No student shall be given failing and incomplete grades.** If the student fails to submit the requirements on the adjusted schedule, i.e. 30 June 2020, he/she shall be given a mark of **"No Grade"** on the remarks section on the grading sheet and the student shall be given one year to comply with such deficiency. If the student cannot comply within one year, he/she shall be given a **"Dropped"** remark.

Faculty shall submit the students' grades after 11 working days from the deadline of submission of students' requirements, i.e. 16 July 2020. The 11 working days' period shall also apply to the submission of Thesis Grades.

E. Teaching complement

The global pandemic suggests that the threat will be existent for a longer period of time. DNSC is resourceful in providing students with quality instruction even amidst crisis. It delivers instruction in a flexible way without compromising the quality of instruction and learning experiences of students. Hence, DNSC addresses and complements student and faculty level issues on no/slow internet connectivity, limited ICT Infrastructure and on-line gadgets, and inadequate capacity of faculty on flexible learning.

a. Learning Management System

The Faculty Teaching Force is provided with the DNSC Learning Management System (LMS), a platform to provide learning materials to students and for monitoring purposes. All students are enrolled the LMS using their DNSC email accounts. A corresponding account manager is provided to help the Faculty in the use of the LMS.



b. Capability Building

The College capacitated all Faculty through series of webinars for Flexible Learning, Course Pack Development and Use of Learning Management System (LMS) and other On-line Platforms through the ITSO and Regional XI Consortia for the Flexible Learning through Project WRITE.

c. Module Development

The College implements coursepack/Module Development consistent with the format and contents of the Regional WRITE Project. Faculty shall upload to the LMS weekly the modules and instructional materials for students use and for monitoring purposes.

d. ICT facilities and Infrastructure

The College is also facing problems with its Internet connection which is deemed vital in transferring information as well as in doing research/paper-works of faculty and students. The existing internet connection in the main campus will be upgraded in bandwidth to cater to the needs of all units. Additional high-speed computers and communication facilities are procured for frontline services. Moreover, computers are provided for faculty to support flexible learning. Zoom subscription are also provided to provide venue for virtual meetings among academic units.

V. DELIVERY AND ASSESSMENT ON FL BASED ON OUTCOMES-BASED EDUCATION

The delivery of instruction through Flexible Learning shall be based on the approved Outcomes-Based Syllabus of each course which is primarily anchored on the Program Outcomes specified on the CMO of each academic program. The syllabus is detailed and indicates the course learning outcomes (CLO), topics, desired learning outcomes (DLO), teaching and learning activities (TLAs), Assessment Tasks (ATs) Mode of Submission, Resource Materials, Schedule, Summative Test and Grading System. The Summative Tests for both midterm and final exams are also indicated in the Table of Specifications (TOS) and such constitute a higher percentage in the grading criteria.

VI. MECHANISM FOR STUDENTS TO RECEIVE AND ACCESS PRINTED OR DIGITAL COURSE PACKAGES AND INSTRUCTIONAL MATERIALS

The faculty are required to provide students with Self Learning Modules as instructional material for each course. Faculty shall maximize the use of the DNSC Learning Management System (LMS) to provide learning materials/modules to students and for monitoring purposes.

For every class, faculty will enroll the students to the LMS using their DNSC email accounts. The Deans and Program Chairpersons shall also be enrolled in the LMS of faculty as a co-teacher for monitoring and mentoring purposes. Modules and instructional materials duly checked by the Institute/Department shall be uploaded to the LMS at least one day before the scheduled class. To provide ample time, submission of students' outputs to the LMS shall be done within the prescribed period. Students with poor or no internet connectivity shall be provided with printed modules by concerned faculty. The printed modules shall be submitted to the faculty through LMS or any mode of delivery for those students using with Off-line Instructional Materials.

Every opening of the school year, each academic program is required to assess the freshmen and monitor old students' internet capacity and gadgets to decide on the approaches to be used for the student, based on the CHED memo No. 04 series of 2020 on the level and use of Technology



per category, availability of devices, internet connectivity, level of digital literacy and approaches (Table below). These shall be recommended and forwarded to the faculty handling the subject, which means several approaches shall be applied to students in the class depending on the result assessment. Thus, students with poor or no internet connection shall be provided with printed modules.

Table 1. Approaches based on the Level of Digital Literacy

CATEGORIES	AVAILABILITY OF DEVICES	INTERNET CONNECTIVITY	LEVEL OF DIGITAL LITERACY	APPROACHES
High Level Technology	Laptops, mobile phones, tablets, desktops	Fast	Proficient	Online learning or blended learning technology
Medium Level Technology	Mostly available phones	Slow	Advanced	Macro and micro learning approach (a mix of online and offline activities)
Low Level Technology	Some mobile phones or no technology	Poor or no internet connection	Beginner	Self-instructional modules/mostly offline activities

VII. MECHANISMS TO ENSURE HONESTY WHILE ON FLEXIBLE LEARNING

Academic Integrity Statement and Agreement
(adopted from Dr. Jonathan A. Bayogan)

The Davao del Norte State College seeks to foster a teaching and learning environment that supports the academic development of its students and the development of professional ethics which the students are expected to demonstrate in their decisions and actions and accept responsibility for the consequences. In keeping with integrity as one of its core values, the College adheres to the belief that effective learning, teaching and research are anchored on the mutual trust and trustworthiness of all members of the academic community. This is especially true to the integrity of the work submitted for academic credit (exams, papers, assignments, etc) and those conducted in the wider arena of research. As a public higher education institution that operates on peoples’ resources, integrity and responsibility comes with a greater cost. Thus, this Academic Integrity Statement is made to combat cheating, plagiarism and academic dishonesty and develop integrity as a value among students and all members of the academic community.

Scope and Purpose

For the purpose of this statement, academic integrity is the commitment to uphold the values of honesty, trust, fairness, respect and responsibility, and the courage to act on them affirmatively in all circumstances. Applied to academic work, the ideas and contributions of others must be appropriately acknowledged and work that is presented as original must, in fact, be original. Faculty, students and administrative staff all share the responsibility of ensuring the honesty and fairness of the intellectual environment. This academic integrity statement and agreement intends to clarify expectations with regard to graduate students’ academic behavior and to provide specific examples of unacceptable conduct in academic integrity.



Violations to This Statement

This list of violations to this Academic Integrity Statement include, but not limited to:

1. Plagiarism. Plagiarism is taking someone else's ideas, words or other types of work (e.g. infographic, artwork, sketch, diagram, photograph, etc.) and presenting them as one's own. To avoid plagiarism, students must always:

- Enclose every quotation in quotation marks and acknowledge its source.
- Cite the source of every summary, paraphrase, abstraction or adaptation of material originally prepared by another person and any factual data that is not considered common knowledge. Include the name of author, title of work, publication information and page reference.
- Acknowledge material obtained from lectures, interviews or other oral communication by citing the source (name of the speaker, the occasion, the place and the date).
- Cite material from the internet as if it were from a traditionally published source. Follow the citation style or requirements of the person for whom the work is produced.

2. Cheating on an Examination. A student must not receive or provide any unauthorized assistance on an examination. During an examination a student may use only materials authorized by the faculty.

3. Copying or Collaborating on Assignments without Permission. Collaborative learning is a good thing but when assessment of individual learning is involved, collaboration is a different matter. When a student submits work with only his/her name on it, this is a written statement that credit for the work belongs to that student alone. If the work was a product of collaboration, each student is expected to clearly acknowledge in writing all persons who contributed to its completion.

Unless the professor explicitly states otherwise, it is dishonest to collaborate with others when completing any assignment or test, performing laboratory or field experiments or activities, writing and/or documenting computer programs or activities, writing papers or reports and completing problem sets.

If the professor allows group work in some circumstances but not others, it is the student's responsibility to understand the degree of acceptable collaboration for each assignment and to ask for clarification if necessary.

4. Fabrication or Falsification of Data or Records. It is dishonest to fabricate or falsify data in laboratory experiments, research papers, reports or in any other circumstances; to fabricate source material in a bibliography or "works cited" list; or to provide false information on a résumé or other document in connection with academic efforts. It is also dishonest to take data developed by someone else and present them as one's own.

5. Other Forms of Deceit, Dishonesty or Inappropriate Conduct. Under no circumstances is it acceptable for a student to: 1.) Submit the same work, or essentially the same work, for more than one course without explicitly obtaining permission from professors; 2.) Request an academic benefit based on false information; 3) Make any changes (including adding or erasing material) on any test paper, problem set or class assignment being submitted for a re-grade; 4) Steal, deface or damage academic facilities or materials; 5) Collaborate with other students planning or engaging in any form of academic misconduct; 6) Submit academic work under someone else's name other than his/her own. This includes but is not limited to sitting for another person's exam where both parties will be held responsible; 7) Engage in any other form of academic misconduct not covered here.

6. Application and Agreements

This statement on academic integrity applies to all graduate and undergraduate students in all classes until such time that the College or the Institute adopts a clear cut policy on this matter. As such, all students are expected to adhere to the highest standards of academic behavior. To agree



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on the Academic Integrity Statement, students shall sign the Academic Integrity statement and agreement (below) or similar document at the beginning of the semester.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY AGREEMENT

I, _____, a graduate/undergraduate student of the Davao del Norte State College, with Student No. _____, hereby agree and adhere to abide by all the rules and regulations of the College and the provisions of this Academic Integrity Statement and Agreement and those that the College may adopt in the future.

I have read and understood the above-stated provisions and the inherent intent and purpose of this Academic Integrity Statement and fully agree to abide by the clearly-stated provisions and its principle. I understand that any violation that I may commit as an individual or as part of a group will have its serious consequences which can be meted with a severe penalty depending on the facts and the gravity of the acts committed. I thereby promise to not to violate academic integrity statement. Thus, I refrain to commit plagiarism, cheating, fabrication, dishonesty, copying or any similar rule that may be promulgated by the College in the future, nor cause any student, employee, or any third person to violate them, throughout the duration of my stay as a student and even after graduation, as long as such act may adversely affect the policies of the College on Academic Integrity.

By signing this Agreement, I shall be bound by the foregoing statements and stipulations.

Conforme:

Signature Over Printed Name of Student

Date: _____

Plagiarism Softwares

The college endeavors to prevent plagiarism within the College. It shall procure plagiarism softwares to check the originality of students and faculty outputs.

Intellectual Property

The College has an Intellectual Property Office (IPO) supervised by the Research, Extension and Production Office to assess applications for grants of Intellectual Property Rights (e.g. patents, utility models, trademarks, copyrights) of the students and Faculty within the College. It shall also protect copyright by facilitating in the IPR application at the IPOPHIL. It shall also facilitate the awareness of faculty for the policies on Intellectual Property. Faculty with completed modules and instructional materials are encouraged to apply of Intellectual property at the IPO Office. The approved Policy on Intellectual Property shall be followed by the

Data Privacy

Pursuant to Republic Act No. 10173, also known as the Data Privacy Act of 2012, The College designated a Data Privacy Officer who shall plan, create policies and institutionalize the Data Privacy Act within the Davao del Norte State College. This is safeguard the fundamental human right of every individual to privacy while ensuring free flow of information for innovation, growth, and national development.

Note: DNSC Policies for Data Privacy Act is on-progress

VIII. CONSTANT DIALOGUE WITH STAKEHOLDERS

a. Parents

A major area of concern as we navigate uncertainties and evolving circumstances during pandemic is how to proceed given that the locus of learning has shifted from schools to homes and the modality of instruction, for most, is transitioning from face-to-face to online.



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A Strong reciprocal relationships with Parents and educators are key to keeping students and involved in the learning process. Maintaining current contact information is essential to connect with students and families who might need support

Consultation with parents shall be held per year as transitions are occurring in a general context of stress and worry, and are happening simultaneously with many parents making similar shifts in their lives.

b. Communication with Clients and Outside Community

The Davao del Norte State College shall provide and update the necessary information to its clients through various communication media (Website and FB Page, IAIMS, Posters, and Brochures). Frequently asked questions (FAQs) in the DNSC FB Page will be regularly monitored by the authorized personnel. The contact information of frontline offices in both Academics and Administrative Services shall be made available on-line particularly the Units' FB account, email address, and contact numbers and also on printed materials (e.g. brochure) to accommodate those who are limited to internet access.

All queries and concerns of clients shall be dealt with immediately with utmost courtesy. Each Unit shall officially assign personnel-in-charge to respond to the queries and concerns of the clients in their respective units via these different communication platforms. These personnel are in addition to the College Press Information Officer who will respond to the matters related to the DNSC in general.

c. Faculty and Staff

Regular communication/meetings shall be held among different units to discuss the queries, monitor the effectiveness of the communication system provided for the clients.

IX. HEALTH AND SAFETY PROTOCOLS

COVID 19 HEALTH & SCREENING AT DNSC

DNSC EMPLOYEES

DNSC Employees shall strictly follow and observe the health protocol set by the College:

1. Undergo hand sanitation, hand washing, for 20 seconds and disinfection of boots and shoes before entering the main gate of the campus;
2. Undergo checking of body temperature every entry at DNSC. The data shall be listed in the DNSC COVID TF Form 1, Annex 1 and such shall be submitted to the DNSC COVID Task Force;
3. Strict implementation of the **“NO FACE MASK, NO ENTRY”**, shall be observed at all times. All DNSC Personnel are required to wear face mask and ARTA ID upon entry and within the office premises;
4. **“SOCIAL DISTANCING”** policy of 3-2 meters physically apart from other person within the office premises. DURING LUNCH TIME AND OTHER GATHERING OF MORE THAN 10 PERSONS, TALKING SHOULD BE AVOIDED!
5. Only Personnel organized and approved in the alternative work arrangement as skeleton workforce shall be allowed entry to minimize the volume of persons inside the office premises unless in the exigency of service;
6. DNSC Personnel who are FRONTLINERS (Security Personnel Guidance, Cashier's Office, Scholarship, Assessment Office, OSS, Registrar's Office, Institute Deans/Program Chairpersons, Clinic, Procurement Service Unit Library) are required to wear Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) such as face mask, face shield



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and gloves especially in dealing with clientele.

7. Every office shall post protocol and put signage and markers for social distancing.
8. In case of possible contact with Covid 19 Positive, PUI and PUM persons, employees are advised to self-quarantine for 14 days from the date of contact and shall observe work from home scheme and shall be prohibited to enter the college premises;
9. Employees manifesting any of the COVID 19 symptoms are also advised to observe work from home scheme. Employees shall immediately inform their respective supervisors through submission of health declaration form.

VISITORS

Visitors shall strictly follow and observe the health protocol set by the College:

1. Visitors must undergo hand sanitation, hand washing for 20seconds and disinfection of boots and shoes before entering the main gate of the campus;
2. Visitors must present to the Security Personnel Certificate from the Barangay that he/she is not declared as PUM or PUI for the past two (2) weeks **SPECIALLY COMING FROM HIGH RISK AREAS;**
3. Undergo checking of body thermal temperature every entry at DNSC. The data shall be listed in the DNSC COVID TF Form 2, Annex 2 and such shall be submitted to the DNSC COVID Task Force;
4. Must fill-out health declaration form (DNSC COVID TF Form 4) every visit;
5. Strict implementation of the “**NO FACE MASK, NO ENTRY**”, shall be observed at all times. All Visitors are required to wear face mask and Valid ID upon entry and within the office premises;
6. “**SOCIAL DISTANCING**” policy of 3-2 meters physically apart from other person within the premises.
7. DNSC occupants shall attest and confirm the entry of its visitors, if possible the DNSC occupant shall meet with them at the DNSC gate.

STUDENTS

Students shall strictly follow and observe the health protocol set by the College:

1. Students must undergo hand sanitation, hand washing for 20seconds and disinfection of boots and shoes before entering the main gate of the campus;
2. Security Personnel must verify name of students from the lists of scheduled visits;
3. Students must present to the Security Personnel Certificate from the Barangay that he/she is not declared as PUM or PUI for the past two (2) weeks **SPECIALLY COMING FROM HIGH RISK AREA;**
4. Undergo checking of body thermal temperature every entry at DNSC. The data shall be listed in the DNSC COVID TF Form 3, Annex 3 and such shall be submitted to the DNSC COVID Task Force;
5. Must fill-out health declaration form (DNSC COVID TF Form 4) every visit;
6. Strict implementation of the “**NO FACE MASK, NO ENTRY**”, shall be observed at all times. All Students are required to wear face mask and Student ID upon entry and within the office premises;
7. “**SOCIAL DISTANCING**” policy of 3-2 meters physically apart from other person within the premises.

ONLINE APPOINTMENT – All transacting public, visitors, students, Faculty and Staff, on off duty and work from home Scheme, shall apply an **Online Appointment** before they are allowed to enter the college premises.

MONITORING AND REPORTING - The DNSC COVID Task Force shall consolidate the



entries of Forms 1, 2, 3 and 4. Monthly presentation of results shall be presented to the Management Team. Regular meeting shall be conducted by the COVID Task Force.

Faculty and Other School Administrative & Support Services Staff

Orientation of Faculty on the new normal is facilitated by the different Unit Heads/Deans through the DNSC communication systems described above.

X. MECHANISMS FOR CONTINUOUS QUALITY IMPROVEMENT

A. ISO 9001:2015 Compliance

DNSC's commitment to its clients, is expressed in its Quality Policy Statement, is to provide quality, excellent, and timely services that are responsive to the needs of our stakeholders following the principles of good governance and in adherence to our core values. DNSC strives to improve and align its services to this statement. DNSC was just assessed and passed the ISO 9001:2015 2nd Surveillance Remote Audit on September 21- 22, 2020. One of the Major areas being audited was the Instructional Delivery.

Academic requirements primarily Syllabus, Summative Exams with Table of Specifications and modules are still shall adhere to prescribed content format by the ISO and Project WRITE. These shall be submitted and shall be subject to quality control by the Program Chairperson and Institute Deans.

Faculty shall use of the DNSC Learning Management System (LMS) to provide learning materials to students and for monitoring purposes. The Deans and Program Chairpersons shall also be enrolled in the LMS of faculty as a co-teacher for monitoring and mentoring purposes.

B. Research and Innovations

DNSC conducts regular assessment on the on-line capacity and challenges of both students and Faculty as inputs to the Management Interventions during the New Normal and Community Quarantine.

A college-wide Research Program on the Impact of the Flexible Learning on the students, faculty, governance and responses is currently conducted for informed decision making. This covers the implementation of Flexible Learning across, profiling of students and faculty of all programs, both graduate and undergraduate programs.

XI. EXPLORE/IMPLEMENTATION OF GRANTS AND/OR SUPPORT CAPACITY PROGRAMS FOR ADMINISTRATORS, FACULTY AND STAFF

A. Grants

While transitioning to flexible learning, the Davao del Norte State College shall explore grants and/or support capacity building of the Faculty.

The College shall continually implement projects through local and external funds to capacitate the DNSC Faculty towards Flexible Learning to increase opportunities and options available to learners through a variety of learning modes and interactions while preventing the spread of Covid 19. These projects shall a) capacitate Faculty on Learning Management System and Other On-line Platforms; b) develop varied Modules and Instructional Materials (Print and non-print) that suit the needs of the learners; c) enhance ICT Infrastructures (laptops and computers), LMS and Internet Connectivity; and 4) provide Covid19 Prevention facilities and Procedures.



B. Consortia

Moreover, the College shall endeavor to join Consortia, partnership in Local and International Level for the Capacity Building, sharing strategies on Flexible Learning, Open Educational Resources, on-line Courses and internationalization initiatives.

C. Capacity Building

The Davao del Norte State College shall continually capacitate the Faculty and Staff on Flexible Learning, Use of LMS, Google Education and other on-line Platforms. It shall also enhance the Internet connectivity at the campus and Laptop Computers to individual faculty and frontline offices.